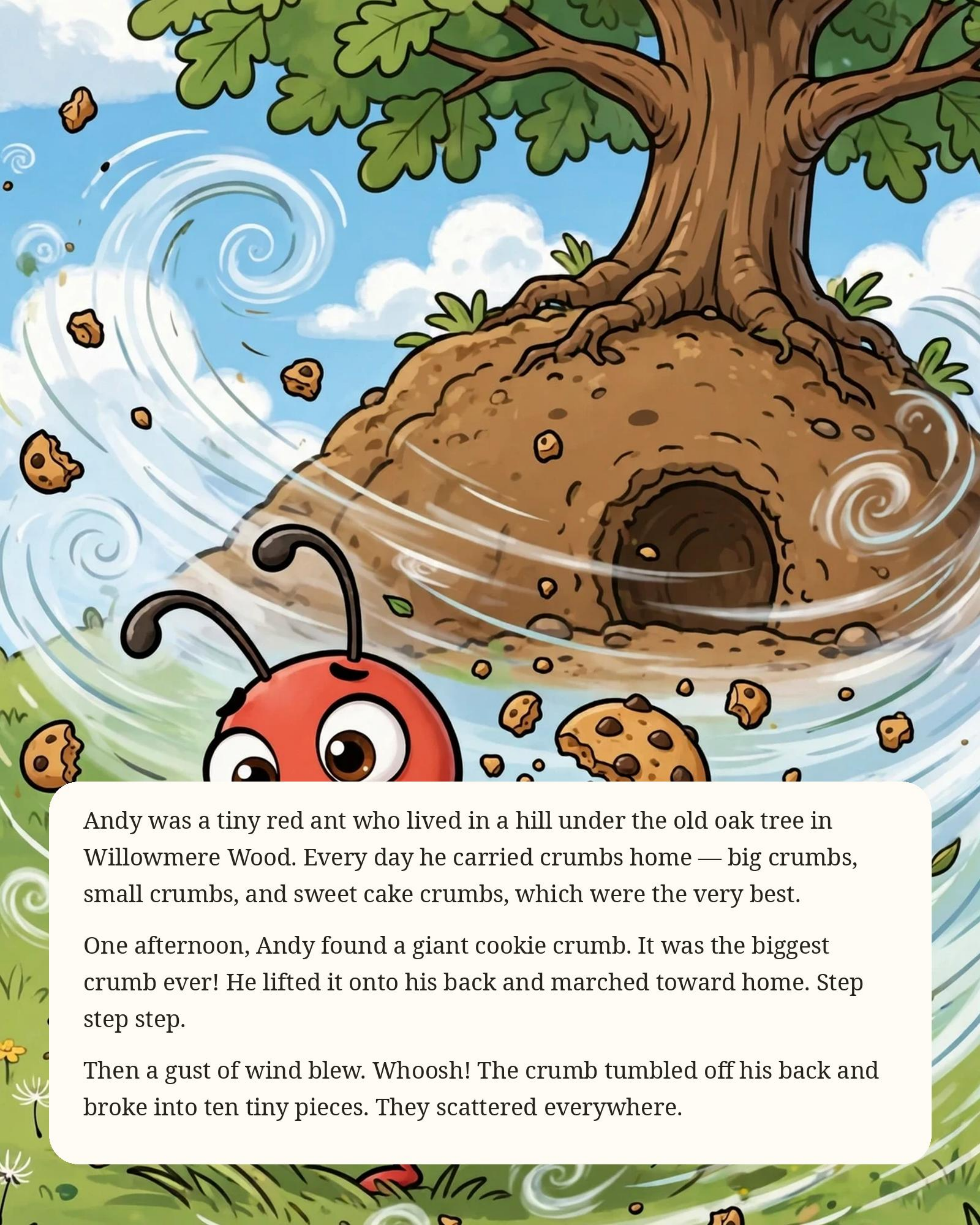


Bedtime Tales

Andy the Ant and the Fallen Crumbs



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



Andy was a tiny red ant who lived in a hill under the old oak tree in Willowmere Wood. Every day he carried crumbs home — big crumbs, small crumbs, and sweet cake crumbs, which were the very best.

One afternoon, Andy found a giant cookie crumb. It was the biggest crumb ever! He lifted it onto his back and marched toward home. Step step step.

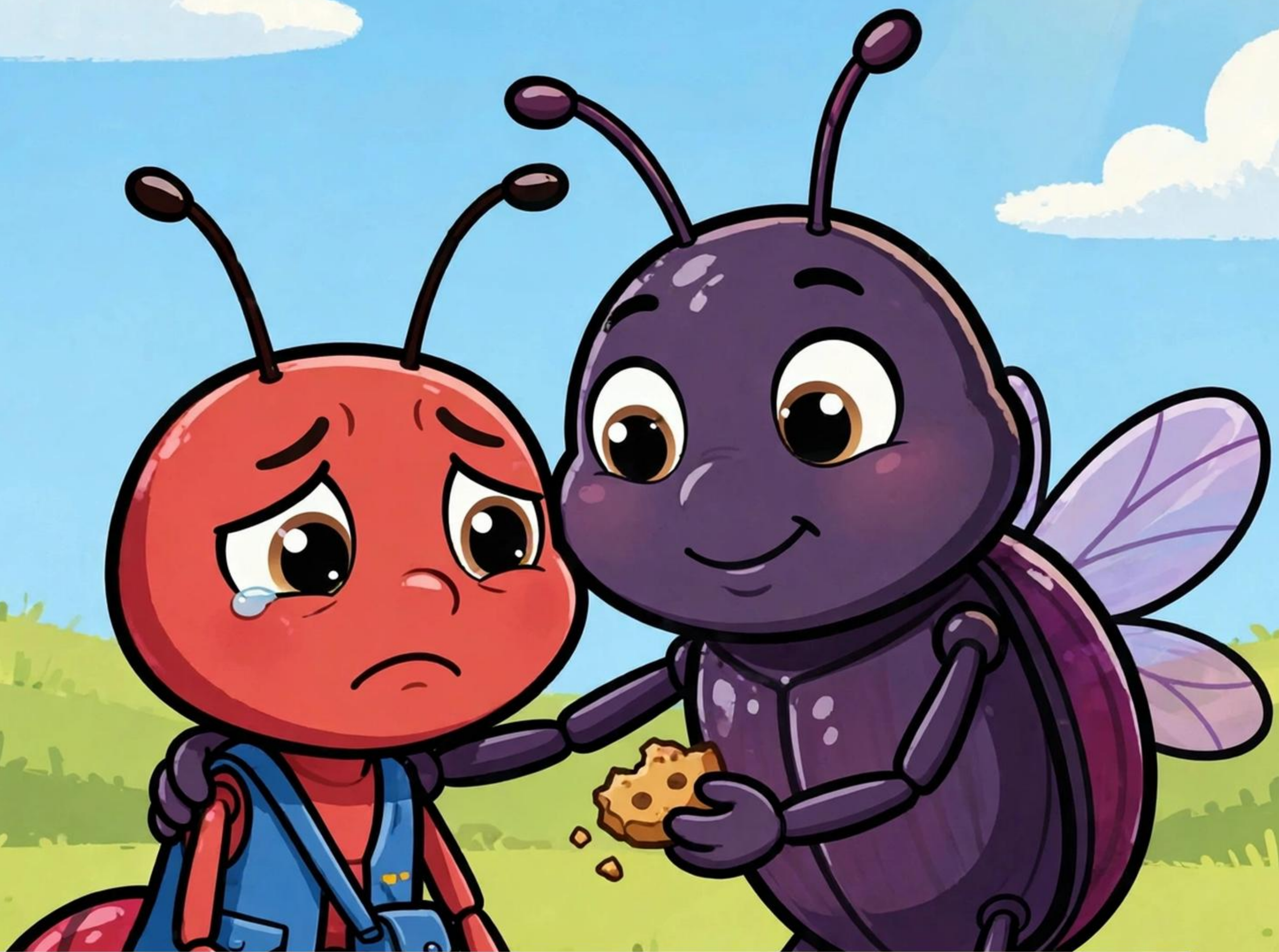
Then a gust of wind blew. Whoosh! The crumb tumbled off his back and broke into ten tiny pieces. They scattered everywhere.



Andy's shoulders drooped. "My big crumb is ruined," he said. His heart sank. All that work for nothing.

His friend Bella the beetle crawled over. She saw the scattered pieces, and she saw Andy's sad face.

"What happened, Andy?" asked Bella.



"The wind broke my crumb," said Andy. "I cannot carry ten pieces alone."

Bella smiled her beetle smile. "You do not have to," she said. "Many small hands make light work."

"Many small hands make light work," Andy repeated softly.



"Many small hands make light work." It became their teamwork chant.

"Many small hands make light work."

Bella called her beetle brothers, and Andy called his ant sisters. Soon ten friends stood in a line, and each friend picked up one piece.



Lift!

They marched together. Step step step.

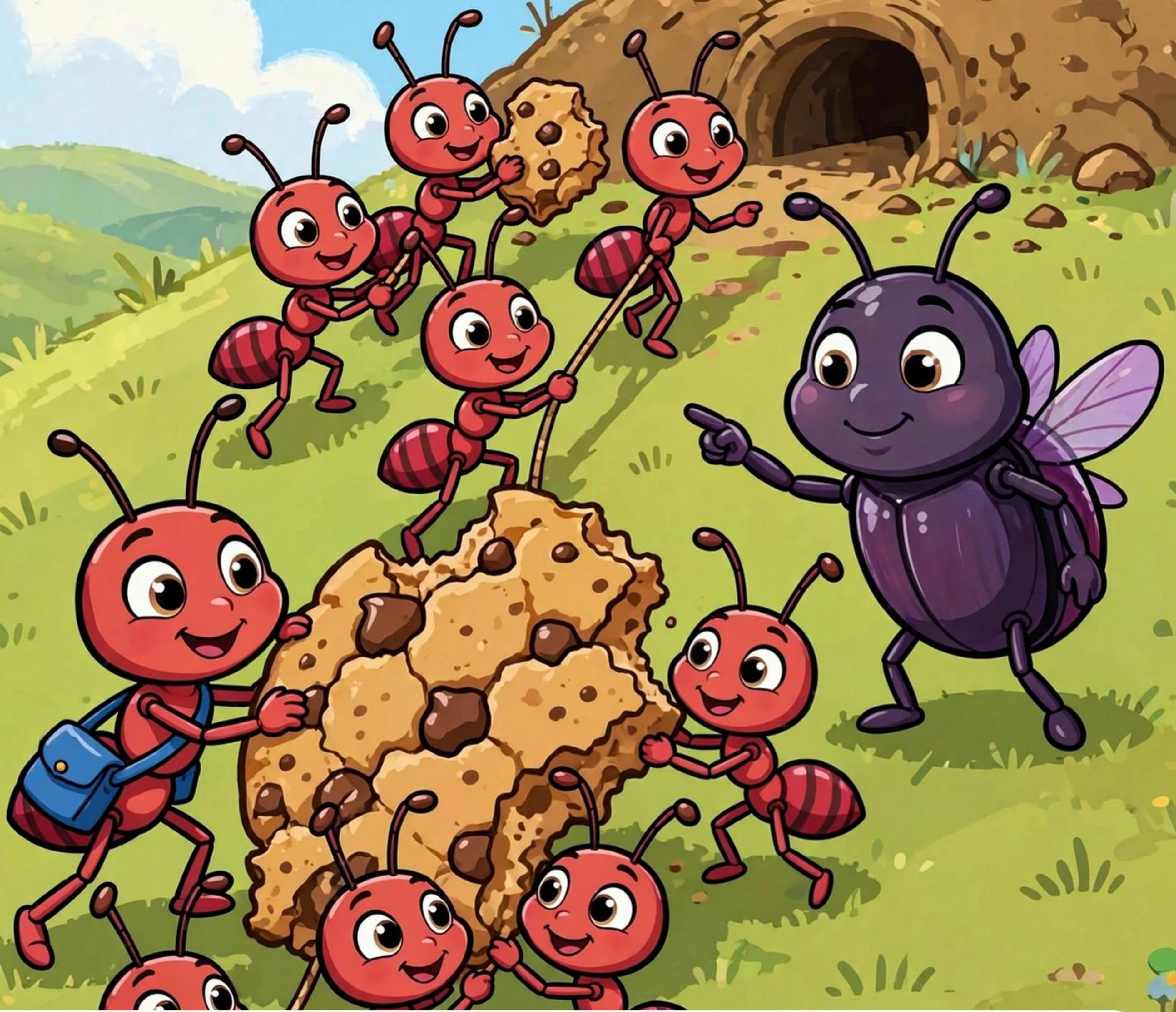
"Many small hands make light work!" they chanted. The line moved like a parade — left, right, left, right — all the way to the ant hill, where they piled the pieces inside.



The cookie crumb was saved! Andy's heart swelled. His friends had turned a mishap into fun.

Can you march like an ant?

Pick up a pretend crumb: lift!



March in place: step step step!

Now put it down gently.

That evening, the ants held a crumb feast. Everyone got a piece of cookie. Crunch crunch crunch. Bella got the biggest piece.



"For the best helper," said Andy.

They told stories and laughed. The moon rose over the oak tree, and Andy felt warm inside. Helping friends was the sweetest crumb of all.

At bedtime, Andy curled into his cozy tunnel while Bella rested in the moss nearby.



"Goodnight, crumb saver," whispered Bella.

"Goodnight," yawned Andy.



He dreamed of cookie crumb parades. Step step step. The earth was soft and dark, and the hill hummed a quiet song. And Andy slept, snug and happy.

Sleep now, little Andy.

Sleep now, little Andy.

The End

